수험영어를 넘어 세상을 보는 창

2026 FALL

SIMSON DEBATE

Sep. B





THBT treating everyone the same cannot achieve true equality

- ☐ **comparable** adj. 비슷한 수준의, 비교할 만한
- ☐ **background** n. 배경, 환경
- ☐ **potential** n. 잠재력, 가능성
- ☐ **severe** adj. 심각한, 심한
- ☐ **pension** n. 연금
- ☐ **occupational** adj. 직업의, 직업과 관련된
- ☐ **barrier** n. 장벽, 장애물
- ☐ **impairment** n. 장애, 기능 손상
- ☐ **qualification** n. 자격, 자격 요건
- ☐ **controversy** n. 논란, 논쟁

DAY 1

Learning about the Topic

Brainstorming

Motion **THBT treating everyone the same cannot achieve true equality**

key terms

treat: to behave toward someone in a particular way

achieve: to succeed in reaching a goal after making an effort

Think about the Motion!

1. Is treating people the same an equal act?

Answers may vary

2. Should people be judged based on their individual abilities or their group identity?

Answers may vary

Vocabulary

Write the correct word for each definition and make a sentence using the word.

comparable	background	potential	severe	pension
occupational	barrier	impairment	qualification	controversy

1. (background) : the conditions or experiences that have influenced a person's life
   e.g _____
2. (occupational) : related to a person's job or profession
   e.g _____
3. (comparable) : similar enough to be compared fairly
   e.g _____
4. (impairment) : a physical or mental condition that limits a person's abilities
   e.g _____
5. (pension) : money regularly paid to someone after they retire from work
   e.g _____
6. (severe) : very serious or extreme
   e.g _____
7. (qualification) : a skill, quality, or achievement needed for a particular position or activity
   e.g _____
8. (controversy) : a public disagreement or debate about an issue
   e.g _____
9. (barrier) : something that makes progress or participation difficult
   e.g _____
10. (potential) : the ability to develop or succeed in the future
    e.g _____

Motion **THBT treating everyone the same cannot achieve true equality**

Purpose To analyze the difference between equality and equity and evaluate how each affects fairness in society.

Background

As societies become more diverse, people are thinking more about what true fairness means. Two important ideas are equality and equity.

Equality means giving everyone the same rules, opportunities, or resources. Supporters say this is fair because everyone is treated by the same standard, and no one is officially favored or excluded.

Equity means giving different support based on each person's needs and situation. Since people may start from different social, economic, or physical conditions, giving everyone the same thing may not create equal opportunities. In this view, fairness is not about sameness, but about ensuring **comparable** chances to succeed.

Therefore, this debate asks whether fairness is better achieved through equality or equity, and whether treating people the same or differently leads to a more just society overall.

Perspective 1 : Structural

Pro (Treating everyone the same can preserve existing inequality)

[Assertion] Treating everyone the same can keep existing inequality because people with more money and better education already have many advantages.

[Reasoning] Equal rules do not remove these advantages. In university admissions, wealthy students may receive expensive private education, consulting, and more information. Students from smaller cities may have fewer chances to access the same level of preparation or guidance. As a result, even if the rules are identical, outcomes can still reflect **background** differences, and the same system can make old social and economic gaps continue across generations.

[Evidence] Research on Seoul National University found that students in Seoul had

an admission rate about 2.6 times higher than students outside Seoul, even when academic **potential** was considered. About 92 percent of this gap was linked to parents' economic resources and private education. This shows that equal standards do not always create equal opportunities, and that structural advantages can strongly influence results.

Con (It is difficult to establish clear criteria)

[Assertion] Equity can create new unfairness because it is difficult to decide who truly needs more support.

[Reasoning] A person's disadvantage may depend on income, property, debt, health, family situation, educational background, and many other factors that are hard to measure fairly. However, public systems must use simple legal rules to function efficiently. Because of this limitation, some people who genuinely need help may be left out, while others may receive support because they fit the official category, even if their real situation is not as **severe**. This can lead to confusion and disagreement about what is "fair."

[Evidence] Korea's Basic **Pension** Act generally excludes people who receive certain **occupational** pensions, such as government employee, military, or private school pensions, and their spouses. However, some retired public officials still have very low incomes due to personal circumstances or high living costs. Even so, they may not receive the basic pension because of their category. This shows that equity can create welfare blind spots and unintended exclusion.

Perspective 2 : Individual

Pro (Equity protects dignity and freedom of choice)

[Assertion] Equity is needed to protect individual dignity and real freedom of choice because people have different needs.

[Reasoning] Giving everyone the same resources does not mean everyone can participate equally in real life. A person with a disability, for example, may face physical, technological, or social **barriers** that others do not experience. Without extra support, that person may have the same legal right but not the same real opportunity to succeed

or participate fully. Equity helps reduce these barriers so that individuals can act more independently and with dignity.

[Evidence] Visually impaired students taking Korea's College Scholastic Ability Test answer the same questions as other students, but they receive extra support. Students with severe visual **impairments** get 1.7 times more test time and may use voice-support computers or Braille devices. This shows that different support can be necessary to create equal opportunity in practice, not just in theory.

Con (Equity can cause reverse discrimination)

[Assertion] Equity can cause reverse discrimination because some people may lose opportunities simply because they are not part of a preferred group.

[Reasoning] People should ideally be judged by their ability, effort, and achievement, not only by group identity or background. However, equity policies may give different advantages based on race, gender, disability, or social background in order to correct historical inequality. While this intention is to improve fairness, it can also create situations where individuals feel they are treated unequally despite their **qualifications**, leading to tension and debate about fairness in selection processes.

[Evidence] In the United States, some universities used race as one factor in admissions to increase opportunities for Black and Hispanic students. Critics argued that this could unfairly disadvantage other applicants with strong academic records. In 2023, the U.S. Supreme Court ruled against the race-conscious admissions programs used by Harvard and the University of North Carolina. This shows that equity can create **controversy** and claims of unfairness when group-based considerations affect limited opportunities.

Reading Comprehension

1. Why does the Pro side argue that applying the same rules can preserve structural inequality?

The Pro side argues that equal rules do not remove the advantages that wealthy students already have. They may have better access to private education, consulting, and information, while students from smaller cities may have fewer chances to prepare well. As a result, the same rules can still produce unequal results.

2. How does the Seoul National University example support the Pro side's structural argument?

The example shows that students in Seoul had an admission rate about 2.6 times higher than students outside Seoul, even when academic potential was considered. About 92 percent of this gap was linked to parents' economic resources and private education. This suggests that family background can strongly affect educational opportunities.

3. Why does the Con side argue that equity can weaken the fairness of public institutions?

The Con side argues that it is difficult to measure each person's disadvantage fairly. Public institutions must use simple legal categories, but people's real situations are much more complex. Because of this, some people who truly need help may be excluded, while others may receive support because they fit an official category.

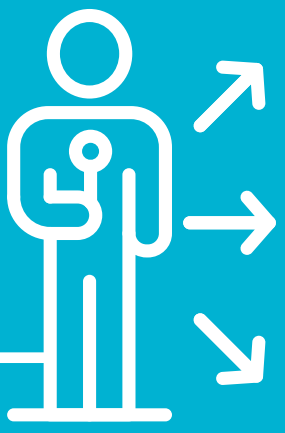
4. Why does the Pro side argue that equity protects individual dignity and freedom of choice?

The Pro side argues that people have different needs and may face different barriers. Giving everyone the same resources may not allow everyone to participate equally in real life. Extra support can reduce these barriers and give people a real chance to study, work, and make their own choices.

5. How does the Con side argue that equity can cause reverse discrimination against individuals?

The Con side argues that equity policies can make some people feel unfairly treated because advantages may be given based on group identity. In U.S. university admissions, race was sometimes considered as one factor, which led to debate about whether some applicants were disadvantaged despite strong qualifications.

DAY 2



Clash Points

Figure out the Clash Points VS ↔

In terms of Structural

1 Proposition argues that:

Reinforcement of Existing Inequality

Treating everyone the same can keep existing inequality because people do not start with the same advantages.

Wealthy students may have better access to private education, consulting, and useful information, while students from smaller cities may have fewer opportunities.

As a result, equal rules can still lead to unequal outcomes and allow existing social gaps to continue.

Rebuttals Limits of Group-Based Preference

The claim that equal treatment always keeps existing inequality is limited.

Social gaps do not always mean that whole groups should receive special advantages.

People in the same group can have very different situations, while some disadvantaged people outside the group may receive no help.

Therefore, support should focus on each person's actual needs and circumstances.

``

In terms of Structural

1 Opposition argues that:

Difficulty in Establishing Clear Criteria

Equity can create new unfairness because it is difficult to decide who truly needs more support.

People's situations depend on many factors, but public systems must use simple legal rules and categories.

As a result, some people who really need help may be left out, creating welfare blind spots.

Rebuttals Improvement of Standards

The claim that equity should be rejected because clear rules are difficult to make is limited.

No welfare system can understand every person's situation perfectly.

However, giving everyone the same support may waste resources and fail to help people with greater needs.

Therefore, the better solution is to improve the rules, not to give up equity.

Figure out the Clash Points VS ↔

In terms of Individual

2 Proposition argues that:

Protection of Individual Dignity and Freedom of Choice

Equity protects individual dignity and freedom of choice because people have different needs.

Giving everyone the same resources may not allow everyone to participate equally in education, work, or society.

Extra support can remove barriers and give each person a fair chance to make choices and succeed.

Rebuttals Equal Rights, Not Different Treatment

The claim that different treatment is necessary to protect dignity and freedom of choice is limited.

Human dignity can also be protected by giving everyone the same basic rights.

If the government keeps treating some people as disadvantaged, it may create stigma and make them depend more on support.

True freedom means making choices and taking responsibility under equal and fair rules.

In terms of Individual

2 Opposition argues that:

Reverse Discrimination Against Individuals

Equity can cause reverse discrimination because some people may receive advantages based on group identity rather than individual ability or effort.

A person may lose an opportunity simply because they do not belong to a group that receives special support.

This can make individuals feel unfairly treated even when they have worked hard or achieved strong results.

Rebuttals Equity Is Not Reverse Discrimination

The claim that equity always causes reverse discrimination is limited.

People do not start from the same conditions because some already have more money, education, information, and social advantages.

Extra support may simply help disadvantaged people take part more fairly.

Therefore, well-designed equity policies can reduce unfair gaps without ignoring individual ability and effort.

DAY 3

Step 1: Finish Your Template

1. Prepare your arguments for both sides at home.
2. Listen to your friend's ideas and add the teacher's tips to complete your template.

Step 2: Practice with a Partner

1. Pair up with a classmate.
2. Take turns being Proposition and Opposition and role-play the debate, using your templates.



Mock Debate Drill

Government

The Government side proposes and defends the motion. The members of the Government side are the following:

1. PM (Prime Minister)

State that you support the motion and present one or two main arguments for the Government side.

2. DPM (Deputy Prime Minister)

Rebut LO's arguments and strengthen PM's Government-side logic. Add extra examples if needed.

3. GW (Government Whip)

Summarize the key issues of the debate and explain why the Government side is more persuasive. Do not add new arguments.

Opposition

The Opposition side refutes and negates the motion. The members of the Opposition side are the following:

1. LO (Leader of Opposition)

State that you oppose the motion and present one or two main arguments for the Opposition side.

2. DLO (Deputy Leader of Opposition)

Rebut PM's arguments and strengthen LO's Opposition-side logic. Add extra examples if needed.

3. OW (Opposition Whip)

Summarize the key issues of the debate and explain why the Opposition side is more persuasive. Do not add new arguments.

Prime Minister

Hello everyone, I am the Prime Minister. First, let me introduce to you the motion of the debate.

Today, I strongly support the motion that treating everyone the same cannot achieve true equality.

First, from a structural perspective, *Write the main argument in a sentence.*▸ treating everyone the same can keep existing social inequality.

Equal rules do not remove the advantages that wealthy students already have. They may have better access to private education, consulting, and useful information, while students from smaller cities may have fewer chances. As a result, the same rules can still lead to unequal outcomes.

For example, research on Seoul National University found that students in Seoul had an admission rate about 2.6 times higher than students outside Seoul, even when academic potential was considered. About 92 percent of this gap was linked to parents' economic resources and private education.

Now let us look at the individual perspective.

From an individual perspective, *Write the main argument in a sentence.*▸ equity is needed to protect dignity and real freedom of choice.

Giving everyone the same resources does not mean that everyone can participate equally. People with disabilities may face barriers that others do not, so extra support may be needed to give them a fair chance.

For example, visually impaired students taking Korea's College Scholastic Ability Test answer the same questions as other students, but students with severe visual impairments receive 1.7 times more test time and may use voice-support computers or Braille devices.

In conclusion, treating everyone in the same way does not always create true equality.

Equal rules can keep existing social gaps, while ignoring different needs can prevent some people from participating equally. Therefore, true equality requires equity, which gives people the support they need to have a fair chance.

visual resources chance academic equity
advantages create disabilities unequal needs

Leader of Opposition

Hello everyone, I am the Leader of Opposition, and I stand firmly against the motion.

Today, I strongly oppose the motion that treating everyone the same cannot achieve true equality.

First, from a structural perspective, *Write the main argument in a sentence.*▸ equity can create new unfairness because it is difficult to decide who really needs extra support.

People's situations depend on many things, such as income, property, debt, and health. However, public institutions must use simple legal rules and categories. Because of this, some people who really need help may be left out, while others may receive support because they fit the rules.

For example, Korea's Basic Pension Act excludes people who receive some occupational pensions, such as government employee, military, and private school pensions, as well as their spouses. Some retired public officials may still have low incomes but receive no basic pension because of this rule.

Now let us look at the individual perspective.

From an individual perspective, *Write the main argument in a sentence.*▸ equity can cause reverse discrimination by giving advantages based on group identity rather than personal ability or effort.

Every person should be judged as an individual. However, if policies give special advantages based on race, gender, disability, or social background, some people may lose opportunities even when they have worked hard or achieved strong results.

For example, some U.S. universities considered race in admissions to increase diversity. Critics argued that this could unfairly disadvantage other applicants. In 2023, the U.S. Supreme Court ruled against these race-conscious admissions programs.

In conclusion, treating everyone differently does not always create true equality.

Equity can create unfair rules and disadvantage people based on group identity. Therefore, true equality should use clear standards and judge each person fairly as an individual.

diversity receive situations clear background
judged support incomes legal disadvantage

Deputy Prime Minister

Hello everyone, I am the Deputy Prime Minister.

I will first rebut the Opposition LO's arguments and then reinforce the Government's position.

The LO argues that equity is unfair because it is difficult to decide who truly needs extra support.

However, no welfare system can understand every person's situation perfectly. The better solution is to improve the rules, not to give everyone the same support.

The LO also argues that equity causes reverse discrimination by giving advantages based on group identity.

However, people do not start from the same conditions because some already have more money, education, information, and social advantages. Extra support can help disadvantaged people compete more fairly without ignoring individual ability and effort.

Now let me reinforce the Government's stance.

From a social perspective, equity can reduce inequality and strengthen social unity.

If social and economic gaps continue for a long time, people may lose trust in society and conflict between groups may increase. Giving more support to people with greater needs can reduce these gaps and create more equal opportunities.

For example, Nordic countries such as Denmark and Sweden use progressive tax systems, where people with higher incomes pay higher tax rates. These countries also rank highly in social mobility, equality, and happiness, showing that different support can help build a more stable society.

Therefore, treating everyone the same cannot achieve true equality.

mobility identity trust ability continue
welfare stable compete strengthen improve

Deputy Leader of Opposition

Hello everyone, I am the Deputy Leader of Opposition.

I will rebut the PM's arguments and reinforce the Opposition's position.

The PM argues that equal ___treatment___ keeps existing inequality because people start from different social and economic conditions.

However, ___social___ gaps do not always mean that whole groups should receive special advantages. People in the same group can have very different situations, so support should focus on each person's actual needs.

The PM also argues that different treatment is needed to protect ___dignity___ and freedom of choice.

However, human dignity can also be protected by giving everyone the same ___basic___ rights. If the government keeps treating some people as disadvantaged, it may create ___dependence___ rather than independence.

The DPM argues that equity can reduce inequality and strengthen social unity.

However, giving ___priority___ to certain groups in limited opportunities can make others feel unfairly ___excluded___ and increase conflict between groups.

Now let me reinforce the Opposition's position.

From a social perspective, equity can increase social conflict and weaken social unity.

Different treatment can divide society into groups that receive benefits and groups that do not. People who are left out may feel that the ___system___ is unfair, while people who receive benefits may be seen as successful because of special treatment.

For example, regional talent recruitment in Korean public institutions gives advantages to graduates from universities in certain ___regions___. This policy has been ___criticized___ for causing reverse discrimination and conflict among job seekers.

Therefore, treating everyone the same can achieve true equality.

priority	dignity	regions	system	treatment
criticized	basic	excluded	social	dependence

Government Whip

Hello everyone, I am the Government Whip

The DLO argues that different treatment increases tension and conflict between social groups.

However, removing extra support does not remove the main causes of conflict. If existing inequality continues, disadvantaged groups may feel more frustration and lose trust in society.

From a structural perspective, the key clash point is whether equal rules can be fair when people start from unequal conditions.

The Opposition focuses on the difficulty of making fair rules, but the Government shows that equal treatment can leave existing economic and educational advantages unchanged.

From an individual perspective, the key clash point is whether equal treatment truly protects freedom and dignity.

The Opposition supports the same basic rules for everyone, but the Government shows that people with different needs may require extra support to participate equally.

Therefore, the Government wins because true equality is not only about giving everyone the same rules. It is also about reducing unequal starting conditions and giving people a real chance to participate and succeed.

For these reasons, treating everyone the same cannot achieve true equality.

participate existing frustration protects educational
tension succeed remove reducing difficulty

Opposition Whip

Hello everyone, I am the Opposition Whip

From a structural perspective, the key clash point is whether ____equity____ can create a fairer system without creating new unfairness.

The Government argues that people with different starting conditions need different support, but the Opposition shows that governments cannot perfectly decide who is disadvantaged. ____Simple____ rules and categories may ____leave____ out people who truly need help while helping others who simply ____fit____ the official rules.

From an individual perspective, the key clash point is whether fairness should be based on ____personal____ ability or group identity.

The Government argues that ____extra____ support gives disadvantaged people better opportunities, but the Opposition shows that some individuals may ____lose____ opportunities because of race or social background rather than their own ability and ____effort____.

Therefore, the Opposition wins because true equality needs clear rules and fair treatment for each person. Equity may try to reduce disadvantage, but ____unclear____ categories can create new ____unfairness____ and group-based advantages can weaken individual merit.

For these reasons, treating everyone the same can achieve true equality.

effort simple unfairness equity lose
unclear personal fit extra leave

Practice with Your Partner

☞ **Role play with your partner for 10 minutes based on the template.**

My Partner:

Round 1

My role:	Proposition / Opposition
Stance:	

Notes

Round 2

My role: Proposition / Opposition

Stance:

Notes

DAY 4

☞ **Actual Debate**

try it without looking at the templates for Proposition and Opposition!

The more you practice at home, the more confident you will be!



Actual Debate

Debate Judge ballot

Tournament: Simson Debate Competition 2024		Date:
Round:	Room:	Print Judge Name:
Motion:		

PROP TEAM *name:*		**OPP TEAM** *name:*	

List the last names of the speakers of each team below, along with their score *(see rubric on the back)*.
REMINDER: Scores should be between 67-83 for the three speeches. *(see scoring standards on back)*.

Proposition Speakers		Opposition Speakers	
1	Name:	1	Name:
Speaker 1 Total Points *(67–83)*:	/83–67	Speaker 1 Total Points *(67–83)*:	/83–67
2	Name:	2	Name
Speaker 2 Total Points *(67–83)*:	/83–67	Speaker 2 Total Points *(67–83)*:	/83–67
3	Name:	3	Name:
Speaker 3 Total Points *(67–83)*:	/83–67	Speaker 3 Total Points *(67–83)*:	/83–67

THE TEAM WITH THE MOST POINTS, WINNING THE DEBATE IS: *(There are no 'low point wins'—the team with the higher score wins)*

TEAM NAME:		REPRESENTING THE *(circle one)*:	PROPOSITION	OPPOSITION

PROP TOTAL POINTS:		**OPP TOTAL POINTS:**	

COMMENTS:

Judge Signature:	Campus:

Debate Instructions to Judges

DIRECTIONS:

In the Simson debate, the winning team is the one with the most points—there are no low-point wins. Use the guidelines below to determine your scores.

STANDARDS FOR SCORING:
Every speech is scored out of a possible 83 points.

Note: For purposes of consistency, scores should be between 67 and 83 for the three speeches per team. Judges should not go outside this range.

You may give or take away 1 or 2 points, per debater, for strong/weak offering and receiving of Points of Information.

81-83	• Brilliant arguments successfully engage with the main issues in the round. • Arguments are very well-explained, always central to the case being advocated, and demand extremely sophisticated responses. • The speech is very clear and incredibly compelling. Structure and role fulfillment are executed flawlessly.
79-80	• Very good, central arguments engage well with the most important issues on the table and are highly compelling; sophisticated responses would be required to refute them. • Delivery is clear and very persuasive. Role fulfillment and structure are probably flawless.
77-78	• Relevant and pertinent arguments address key issues in the round with sufficient explanation. • The speech is clear in almost its entirety, and holds one's attention persuasively. • Role is well-fulfilled and structure is unlikely to be problematic.
74-76	• Arguments are almost exclusively relevant, and frequently persuasive. Occasionally, but not often, the speaker may slip into: i) deficits in explanation, ii) simplistic argumentation vulnerable to competent responses, or iii) peripheral or irrelevant arguments. • The speaker holds one's attention, provides clear structure, and successfully fulfills their basic role on the table.
72-73	• Arguments are generally relevant, and some explanation of them given, but there may be obvious gaps in logic, multiple points of peripheral or irrelevant material and simplistic argumentation. • The speaker mostly holds the audience's attention and is usually clear, but rarely compelling, and may sometimes be difficult to follow. • There is a decent but incomplete attempt to fulfill one's role on the table, and structure may be imperfectly delivered.
70-71	• Relevant arguments are frequently made, but with very rudimentary explanation. • The speaker is clear enough to be understood the vast majority of the time, but this may be difficult and/or unrewarding. • Structure poor; poor attempt to fulfill role.
69	• The speaker is often relevant, but rarely makes full arguments. • Frequently unclear and confusing; really problematic structure/lack thereof; some awareness of role.
68	• The speech rarely makes relevant claims, only occasionally formulated as arguments. • Hard to follow, little/no structure; no evident awareness of role.
67	• No structure or fulfillment of role in any meaningful sense is provided, OR did not speak at all.

What is a POI?

A POI means **Point Of Information**
It is something you raise during the speech of your opponent when something in their speech doesn't add up or when you want a clarification to something they have said.

A POI is a very important part of a debate since you get to either rebut or question your opponents arguments or definitions in real time!

You may raise a POI by respectfully saying "point" and raising your right hand during your opponent's speech.

You may raise a point after your opponents first definition or argument.
If your opponent has not introduced any definitions or arguments you may not raise a point, since there is nothing to clarify in that case.

But, note that all speakers have the freedom to accept or reject any offered POI's.

So if your POI has been denied please respect the speaker for doing so.

Let's Make a POI!

1.

2.

3.

4.

5.

Actual Debate

Academic Essay

Essay Writing Guide

☞ **We will write an essay using what we learned in Day 1(motion), Day 2(clash points), and Day 3(debate templates).**

☞ **Write your essay online in 4 paragraphs:**

Intro - Body 1 - Body 2 - Conclusion

Instruction	Write like this!
[Intro] In the Intro, **we use the motion**. Do you agree or disagree with the motion we learned?	I (agree / disagree) with the motion, “ _____ .” *(motion)*
[Body] **In the Body, we write the reasons for our side (agree or disagree).** **Use examples or explanations from the** **① text (Day1),** **② clash points (Day2),** **③ Templates (Day3).** **④ or your own ideas.**	**Body 1** The most important reason is that _____ . I think this is important because _____ . For example, _____ . **Body 2** The next important reason is that _____ . I also believe this matters because _____ . For example, _____ .
[Conclusion] The Conclusion is the ending. ① Summarize your Body ② Restate your opinion about the motion	① In conclusion, I (agree / disagree) with the motion because _____ and _____ . ② Therefore, _____ .

↳ Example

Intro

I agree with the motion that treating everyone the same cannot achieve true equality.

Body 1

The most important reason is that people do not start with the same advantages.

I think this is important because wealthy students may have better access to private education, consulting, and useful information. Students from smaller cities may have fewer opportunities to prepare.

For example, research on Seoul National University found that students in Seoul had a higher admission rate than students outside Seoul. This shows that equal rules can still lead to unequal outcomes.

Body 2

The next important reason is that people have different needs and may face different barriers.

I believe this matters because giving everyone the same resources does not always allow everyone to participate equally. Some people may need extra support to have a fair chance.

For example, visually impaired students taking Korea's College Scholastic Ability Test receive extra test time and may use voice-support computers or Braille devices.

Conclusion

In conclusion, I agree with the motion because equal rules can keep existing inequality and people may need different support to have equal opportunities.

Therefore, treating everyone the same cannot achieve true equality.